

Academic Interaction: Roles and Responsibilities

Leader

You will be start and control/direct the discussion but without turning it into a series of mini-presentations. Imagine you're a referee. You might need to stop it going too off-topic, or to encourage people to speak (using some open questions).

For this role, you should think of some questions about the text's key points that you can use to facilitate the discussion. You're not expected to control this tightly, as all members should be focused on discussing not waiting for permission!

Contextualiser

You will put the text into context. This means using the internet to look at the people, academics, places, events, any important pieces of research etc. mentioned in the text.

Providing information about these details will help members to have a deeper understanding of the text in particular and the subject in general.

Visualiser

This creative role is aimed at finding information in the text that could be graphically represented.

It could be pictures of people, places, maps mentioned in the text, as well as graphs and charts based on the data (self-made or found online).

Connector

You will connecting the information from this text to the other information you've studied in the week – in other words, synthesising. Does this text support information from the Topic Input, the Listening or the Reading class? What are the similarities or differences?

You could also link information from the texts to real-life situations that classmates will be familiar with or ask everyone questions based on this.

Highlighter

This involves locating key vocabulary & phrases from the text. Include both academic English phrases that you find useful for general writing, and ideally some discipline-specific phrases that your group could then use in the Timed Writing task on Friday.

You might have noticed some phrases being used across several texts in your weekly classes.

Evaluator

This role involves looking at the article from a critical perspective and asking questions of the source. Is it well-cited? Is it recent, or if not, is it still relevant? Was their research thorough? Are there any issues with the Methodology (e.g. were research samples large/diverse enough)? How applicable is the information, is it just for Europe/USA, or can it be generalised across the world? Are there any points you disagree with?

Summariser

Your job will be to summarise the key points of the text – don't spend a long time writing a summary and reading to everyone, but be prepared to give people a general idea of what the text is saying as and when needed.